Start here: HTTPie CLI

HTTPie is a command-line HTTP client for talking to APIs: `http` and `https` send a request built from short `key=value` arguments and print a colored, formatted response. This repo (version 3.2.4) is the Python package behind those commands and the `httpie` management tool.

```
git clone https://github.com/httpie/cli.git && cd cli
python3 -m venv venv && ./venv/bin/pip install -e '.[dev]'
./venv/bin/http --offline pie.dev/post name=Ada age:=36
```

`--offline` builds and prints the request without sending it, which makes it the quickest way to see what your change does:

```
POST /post HTTP/1.1
Content-Type: application/json
User-Agent: HTTPie/3.2.4
...
{"name": "Ada", "age": 36}
```

Users install it with `pip install httpie` (Python 3.7+). Full user docs live in `docs/README.md` and at https://httpie.io/docs/cli.

Repo map

Path	What lives there
`httpie/__main__.py`, `httpie/core.py`	Entry point, error handling, the main request loop
`httpie/cli/`	Argument definition (`definition.py`), parsing (`argparser.py`), request items (`requestitems.py`), nested JSON syntax (`nested_json/`)
`httpie/client.py`	Turns parsed args into a `requests` request, sends it, follows redirects
`httpie/output/`	Formatting, colors, streaming to the terminal
`httpie/sessions.py`, `config.py`	Saved sessions and the config directory
`httpie/plugins/`	Plugin base classes and loader
`httpie/manager/`	The `httpie cli ...` command (plugins, sessions, update checks)
`tests/`	pytest suite; `tests/utils/__init__.py` has the `http()` test helper

How a request flows

1. `httpie/__main__.py:main` calls `httpie.core.main` (`core.py:146`), which hands the parser from `cli/definition.py:956` to `raw_main` (`core.py:32`).
2. `raw_main` loads plugins, prepends `default_options` from the config file, then parses args with `HTTPieArgumentParser` (`cli/argparser.py:138`). Request items like `name=Ada` become headers, params, data, and files in `RequestItems.from_args` (`cli/requestitems.py:37`).